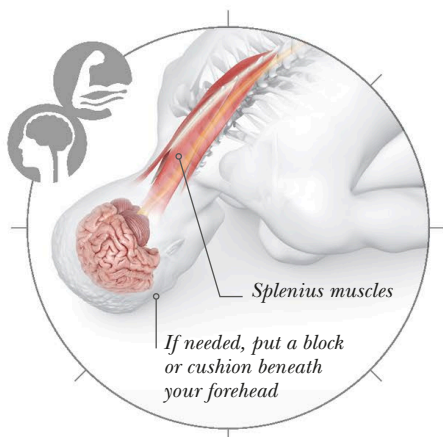


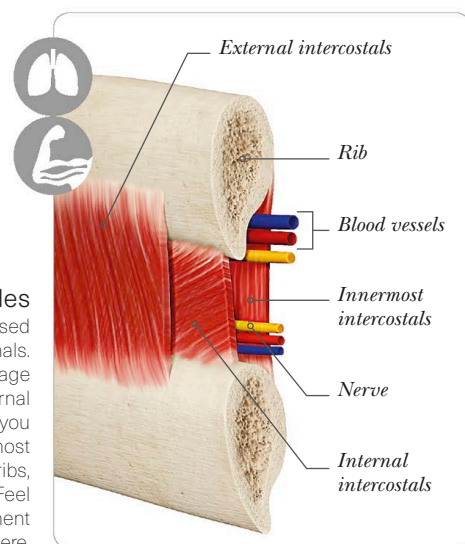
» CLOSER LOOK

Child's pose can be an opportunity to rest, take deep breaths, relax tired muscles, and access a primal sense of safety. If comfortable, you can use this pose as a place of rest and rejuvenation between challenging poses.

**Head rest**

Throughout the day, your neck muscles have the job of holding up the 11lb (5kg) bowling ball that is your head. This muscular activity keeps your nervous system on slight alert. Letting the muscles of your neck and head completely relax lets your nervous system know it is safe to rest.

Neck muscles are completely relaxed

**Intercostal muscles**

Your intercostals are crisscrossed and layered, like your abdominals. Your external intercostals engage to help you inhale. Your internal intercostals engage to help you forcefully exhale. Your innermost intercostals stabilize your ribs, stretching when you inhale. Feel how dynamic your rib movement is while you take deep breaths here.

